

The Boston Globe

Serving our community since 1872

FRIDAY, MAY 29, 2026



PHOTOS BY JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Harvard Law School graduate Ouleye Ndoye (center) held a gavel as she marked the moment with fellow graduates.

A joyous day at a different Harvard

Graduates celebrate reaching their goals after years touched by controversy

By Travis Andersen
and Claire Thornton

GLOBE STAFF

CAMBRIDGE — With a mix of nostalgic quips and political barbs, comedian Conan O'Brien delivered Harvard's 375th commencement address on Thursday, urging graduates to demonstrate humility and empathy in their lives while mocking the Trump administration for its relentless attacks on his alma mater.

"We are living through a period of extreme narcissism," said O'Brien, a Brookline native. "Our current leadership in Washington believes that empathy is a weakness, and that our nation stands supreme and alone. Add



Comedian and Harvard graduate Conan O'Brien held up a letter sweater given to him after his speech.

to that, everyone here today has a phone in their pocket that is algorithmically programmed to celebrate you and you alone, by making you the protein-maxing hero of your own special journey."

Harvard graduates should chart a different path, he said. "If you carry your victories lightly, other qualities — kindness, originality, courage, humor, and humanity — have room to emerge."

The commencement capped off the college careers of students who were present through several politically fueled controversies at Harvard, as well as attacks on academic freedom from the

HARVARD, Page A6

Healey takes more action to curb ICE

Guidelines aim to protect schools, day cares, places of worship from agents

By Samantha J. Gross

GLOBE STAFF

In a warning to federal officials, Governor Maura Healey on Thursday rolled out new guidance for when school officials, child care and health care providers, and others can refuse access to immigration enforcement agents at so-called sensitive locations across Massachusetts.

Healey's announcement offered another plank in the governor's front of resistance against the Trump administration's immigration crackdown. Delivered alongside clergy and state officials, the advice is designed to help calm fears among immigrants who are afraid to send their children to school and day care amid fears of being targeted by Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents.

"I'm taking action to do whatever I can to keep our little kids safe, to keep their parents safe, and to send a message loud and clear to ICE that they need to stay out of Massachusetts and stay out of vulnerable, sensitive spaces," Healey said at an event at the State House on Thursday.

The guidance was promised by an executive order Healey signed in January, which sought to prohibit ICE agents from making arrests in non-public areas of state facilities and barred the use

ICE, Page A5

Ranked choice adds spice to governor's race in Maine

By Sam Brodey

GLOBE STAFF

There are dynastic brand names, seasoned political hands, outsider wild cards, and one COVID-famous doctor among the dozen leading candidates for Maine governor.

Most of them, Democrats and Republicans alike, can actually claim a legitimate shot to win their party's primary on June 9.

But this isn't any regular race. Maine's ranked-choice voting system is adding layers of unpredictability — and drama — to the contests by pushing candidates to forge alliances in hopes of boxing out rivals and boosting their own chances.

While the political oxygen in Maine lately has been consumed by the riveting US Senate election, the race to succeed outgoing Democratic Governor Janet Mills has, comparatively, flown under the radar.

In some respects, this contest is the more dynamic one, and no less significant in its implications for the future of the state and the current mood of both major parties.

On the Democratic side, there are five top candidates, each with their own distinct appeals: Secretary of State Shenna Bellows; former state Senate leader Troy Jackson; entrepreneur Angus

MAINE, Page A6

'Do you cut off the street for those who depend on it and use it every day, just for the World Cup?'

BOSTON CITY COUNCILOR MINIARD CULPEPPER

City and state still at odds over Cup crowd control

No agreement on closing part of Summer Street

By Chris Serres
and Michael Silverman

GLOBE STAFF

With two weeks until the World Cup kicks off, a clash between Mayor Michelle Wu's administration and state transportation officials over crowd-control plans at a major transit hub remains unresolved, raising fresh concerns about Boston's readiness to host the global

event.

Despite hours of closed-door talks over the past week, city and state transportation officials are in a standoff over when — and for how long — to close down a busy section of Summer Street in front of South Station.

At the MBTA's monthly board meeting Thursday, Phil Eng, the T's general manager and the state's interim transportation secretary, reported that he was confident the dispute would be resolved, but he gave no specifics.

With city and state officials tight-lipped, tens of thousands of World

Cup fans remain in limbo as they seek a clearer picture of traffic and pedestrian plans outside City Hall that when the Cup kicks off, with the first game at Gillette Stadium in Foxborough slated for June 13. T officials expect as many as 20,000 fans could ride trains for each of the seven games slated in Foxborough.

Two weeks ago, state transportation officials informed City Hall that they intend to take the unusual step of temporarily occupying part of Summer Street — between South Station and Fort Point Channel — and closing it off to vehicle traffic for 10 hours at a time on match days,

according to a May 15 letter from Eng.

But Boston officials said in a statement last week that the plan is an "inappropriate use of eminent domain to bypass the permitting process for roadways under local jurisdiction."

A spokesperson for Wu did not respond this week to multiple requests for comment on the dispute.

The stalemate is the latest in a string of coordination breakdowns and other missteps surrounding Boston's World Cup preparations. It began early this year with a months-

WORLD CUP, Page A7

R.I.'s pizza secret is out (with the cheese)

Thanks to 'Real Housewives,' the sauce-only pizza chip is having its moment

By Andrea McHugh

GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

It was the pizza chip heard 'round the world — or at least 'round the Bravoverse — when "The Real Housewives of Rhode Island" breakout star Alicia Carmody shared a box of the Ocean State delicacy with castmates on a North Kingstown beach.

For Rhode Islanders, pizza chips are a culinary staple, but for millions of viewers, including just about anyone from Massachusetts, as well as Ashley Iaconetti, one of the cast's few non-Rhode Island natives, the sauce-smothered, cheeseless, room-temperature round of dough was entirely unfamiliar.

"They think it's great, but I'm like, where's the cheese on my pizza, because who wants a pizza without cheese?" asked Iaconetti on episode four. Turns out, plenty of Rhode Islanders do, including Carmody, who staunchly defends the chewy, savory treat she's enjoyed since childhood.

"It's not like a regular pizza," Carmody explained on the show. "It's lighter. People, like, bring it to the beach." The

PIZZA CHIPS, Page A7



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

Rhode Island bakeries have their own variations. These chips are from LaSalle Bakery in Providence.



No-fry zone

Friday: Showers, windy.
High 66-71. Low 44-49.

Saturday: Rain, March-like.
High 50-55. Low 46-51.

Sunrise: 5:11 Sunset: 8:12

Weather and Comics, G6-7.

VOL. 309, NO. 149

*

Suggested retail price
\$4.00



After years of defiance, the Massachusetts Senate voted to turn over records sought by Auditor Diana DiZoglio. **B1.**

US officials are closing in on an agreement with Iran that could lead to the reopening of the Strait of Hormuz while the two countries negotiate. **A3.**

Scientists issued a plea for the state to step in and fund research to help make up for drops in federal support. **B1.**

The Justice Department has opened a criminal investigation into E. Jean Carroll, who accused President Trump of sexual assault and won a civil suit against him. **A2.**

A Massachusetts man set a speed record on Mount Everest, climbing the peak in under 10 hours, his team said. **B1.**